The Neutrino Packages

dist · poly · finance · astro · rmt · phys · scatter · symb — machine-verified

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Contents

A package is a file of `let` definitions; `load("packages/name.nu")` runs it in the current session and its bindings persist. Records of closures act as namespaces (`norm.cdf`), and packages validate their inputs with `assert`, so they fail like builtins do — with a message, not an accident. Every transcript below is machine-verified against the interpreter by `tests/run_manual.sh`, and every numerical claim is cross-checked in the package's own golden tests against an independent reference (SciPy, NumPy, Python's `datetime`, or the `astral` library — named in each section).

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1. dist.nu — probability distributions

Six distributions — `norm`, `student`, `chi2`, `fdist`, `expo`, `unif` — each a record with `pdf`, `cdf`, `inv` (quantile), and `rand`. Parameters are explicit: `norm.cdf(x, mu, sigma)`. Quantiles with no closed form use bracket expansion plus `fzero` on the CDF; the quantile domain is `0 < p < 1`. Cross-checked against SciPy (`tests/34_dist.test`).

```
neutrino> load("packages/dist.nu")
neutrino> norm.cdf(1.96, 0, 1)
0.975002
neutrino> norm.inv(0.975, 0, 1)
1.95996
neutrino> student.inv(0.975, 30)
2.04227
neutrino> chi2.inv(0.95, 3)
7.81473
neutrino> fdist.cdf(3.0, 4, 20)
0.956799
```

A complete two-sample t-test — simulate, test, decide:

```
neutrino> load("packages/dist.nu")
neutrino> rng(42)
neutrino> let x1 = norm.rand(40, 100, 15)
[75.8016; 123.017; 111.725; 93.9971; 100.238; 98.0904; 107.158; 90.1486; 90.4082; 94.4609; 96.6851;
neutrino> let x2 = norm.rand(40, 108, 15)
[102.897; 92.0654; 112.122; 98.9768; 112.891; 112.931; 92.8931; 102.642; 111.903; 100.646; 100.94; 1
neutrino> let t = (mean(x2) - mean(x1)) / sqrt(var(x1)/40 + var(x2)/40)
2.46819
neutrino> 2 * (1 - student.cdf(abs(t), 78))
```

```
0.0157683
```

Out-of-domain probabilities refuse with the package's own message:

```
neutrino> load("packages/dist.nu")
error: quantile: p must be in (0,1), got 1.5
neutrino> student.inv(1.5, 10)
```

Function	Worked example	Result
`norm.pdf/cdf/inv(x, mu, sigma)`	`norm.cdf(1.96, 0, 1)`	`0.975002`
`norm.rand(n, mu, sigma)`	`mean(norm.rand(500, 10, 2)) > 9`	`true`
`student.pdf/cdf/inv(x, v)`	`student.inv(0.975, 30)`	`2.04227`
`chi2.pdf/cdf/inv(x, k)`	`chi2.inv(0.95, 3)`	`7.81473`
`fdist.pdf/cdf/inv(x, d1, d2)`	`fdist.cdf(3.0, 4, 20)`	`0.956799`
`expo.pdf/cdf/inv(x, rate)`	`expo.inv(0.5, 2)`	`0.346574`
`unif.pdf/cdf/inv(x, a, b)`	`unif.cdf(3, 0, 10)`	`0.300000`

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2. poly.nu — polynomials

Coefficients are row vectors, highest power first: `[2, -3, 1]` is $2x^2 - 3x + 1$. Roots come from the companion matrix and `eig` — the same algorithm Octave uses, on Neutrino's LAPACK-verified eigensolver. Cross-checked against NumPy (`tests/37_poly.test`).

```
neutrino> load("packages/poly.nu")
neutrino> polyval([2, -3, 1], 4)
21
neutrino> roots([1, -6, 11, -6])'
[1, 2, 3]
neutrino> roots([1, 0, 1])'
[1i, -1i]
neutrino> companion([1, -6, 11, -6])
[6, -11, 6; 1, 0, 0; 0, 1, 0]
```

Least-squares fitting (Vandermonde + backslash), and calculus that inverts:

```
neutrino> load("packages/poly.nu")
neutrino> let x = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4]
[0, 1, 2, 3, 4]
neutrino> let y = [1.1, 2.9, 9.2, 19.1, 32.8]
[1.1, 2.9, 9.2, 19.1, 32.8]
neutrino> polyfit(x, y, 2)
[1.95714, 0.131429, 1.01429]
neutrino> polyder([1, -6, 11, -6])
[3, -12, 11]
neutrino> polyint(polyder([1, -6, 11, -6]), -6)
[1, -6, 11, -6]
neutrino> conv([1, -1], [1, -2])
[1, -3, 2]
```

Function	Worked example	Result
`polyval(c, x)`	`polyval([2, -3, 1], 4)`	`21`
`roots(c)`	`sort(real(roots([1, -6, 11, -6])))'`	`[1.00000, 2.00000, 3.00000]`
`companion(c)`	`companion([1, 0, -4])`	`[0.00000, 4.00000; 1.00000, 0.00000]`
`polyfit(x, y, n)`	`polyfit([1, 2, 3], [2, 5, 10], 2)`	`[1.00000, -8.32667e-16, 1.00000]`
`polyder(c)`	`polyder([1, -6, 11, -6])`	`[3, -12, 11]`
`polyint(c, k)`	`polyint([3, -12, 11], -6)`	`[1.00000, -6.00000, 11.0000, -6.00000]`
`conv(a, b)`	`conv([1, -1], [1, -2])`	`[1.00000, -3.00000, 2.00000]`

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3. finance.nu — the HP-12C's greatest hits

Time value of money, cash flows, bonds, amortization, and date arithmetic. Sign convention (HP-12C): money received is positive, money paid is negative; rates are per period, as decimals. Cross-checked against SciPy and Python's `datetime` (`tests/38_finance.test`).

The mortgage block — payment, implied rate, savings growth:

```
neutrino> load("packages/finance.nu")
neutrino> pmt(360, 0.005, 250000, 0)
-1498.88
neutrino> rate(360, 250000, -1498.876313, 0)
0.005
neutrino> fv(120, 0.004, 0, -200)
30726.4
```

Cash flows and bonds:

```
neutrino> load("packages/finance.nu")
neutrino> npv(0.10, [-1000, 300, 420, 680])
130.729
neutrino> irr([-1000, 300, 420, 680])
0.163406
neutrino> bond_price(100, 0.08, 0.06, 10, 1)
114.72
neutrino> bond_ytm(114.7202, 100, 0.08, 10, 1)
0.06
neutrino> bond_mduration(100, 0.08, 0.06, 10, 1)
7.0236
```

`amort` returns the whole schedule as a record of columns — a small data frame you can index, sum, and plot:

```
neutrino> load("packages/finance.nu")
neutrino> let s = amort(1000, 0.01, 3)
{period = [1; 2; 3], payment = [340.022; 340.022; 340.022], interest = [10; 6.69978; 3.36656], princi
12]}
neutrino> fields(s)'
["period", "payment", "interest", "principal", "balance"]
neutrino> s.payment[1]
```

```
340.022
neutrino> s.balance'
[669.978, 336.656, 4.26326e-12]
neutrino> sum(s.principal)
1000
```

Dates, HP-12C style — actual day counts, date arithmetic, day of week, and the bond market's 30/360 convention. `datestr` returns a display string, `daterec` the `{y, m, d}` record, and `today()` a serial day number, so arithmetic reads naturally — `datestr(today() + 90)` is the date in 90 days:

```
neutrino> load("packages/finance.nu")
neutrino> days(2026, 1, 1, 2026, 7, 9)
189
neutrino> datestr(datenum(2026, 7, 17) + 90)
"2026-10-15"
neutrino> daterec(datenum(2024, 2, 29))
{y = 2024, m = 2, d = 29}
neutrino> dateadd(2024, 2, 28, 2)
{y = 2024, m = 3, d = 1}
neutrino> dow(2026, 7, 9)
4
neutrino> days360(2024, 1, 31, 2024, 7, 31)
180
neutrino> daterec(today()).y >= 2026
true
```

Function	Worked example	Result
`pmt(n, i, pv, fv)`	`pmt(360, 0.005, 250000, 0)`	`-1498.88`
`pv(n, i, pmt, fv)`	`pv(360, 0.005, -1498.88, 0)`	`250001.`
`fv(n, i, pv, pmt)`	`fv(120, 0.004, 0, -200)`	`30726.4`
`nper(i, pv, pmt, fv)`	`nper(0.005, 250000, -1498.88, 0)`	`359.998`
`rate(n, pv, pmt, fv)`	`rate(360, 250000, -1498.876313, 0)`	`0.00500000`
`npv(r, cfs)`	`npv(0.10, [-1000, 300, 420, 680])`	`130.729`
`irr(cfs)`	`irr([-1000, 300, 420, 680])`	`0.163406`
`bond_price(face, crate, y, n, freq)`	`bond_price(100, 0.08, 0.06, 10, 1)`	`114.720`
`bond_ytm(price, face, crate, n, freq)`	`bond_ytm(114.7202, 100, 0.08, 10, 1)`	`0.0600000`
`bond_duration(face, crate, y, n, freq)`	`bond_duration(100, 0.08, 0.06, 10, 1)`	`7.44502`
`bond_mduration(face, crate, y, n, freq)`	`bond_mduration(100, 0.08, 0.06, 10, 1)`	`7.02360`
`bond_convexity(face, crate, y, n, freq)`	`bond_convexity(100, 0.08, 0.06, 10, 1)`	`65.1716`
`amort(principal, i, n)`	`amort(1000, 0.01, 3).balance[3]`	`4.26326e-12`
`datenum(y, m, d)`	`datenum(2026, 7, 17)`	`2.46124e+06`
`datestr(jdn)`	`datestr(datenum(2026, 7, 17) + 90)`	`"2026-10-15"`

Function	Worked example	Result
`daterec(jdn)`	`daterec(datenum(2026, 7, 17))`	`{y = 2026.00, m = 7.00000, d = 17.0000}`
`dateadd(y, m, d, k)`	`dateadd(2024, 12, 31, 1)`	`{y = 2025.00, m = 1.00000, d = 1.00000}`
`today()`	`today() == datenum(now().y, now().m, now().d)`	`true`
`dow(y, m, d)`	`dow(2026, 7, 17)`	`5.00000`
`days(y1,m1,d1, y2,m2,d2)`	`days(2026, 1, 1, 2026, 7, 17)`	`197.000`
`days360(y1,m1,d1, y2,m2,d2)`	`days360(2024, 1, 31, 2024, 7, 31)`	`180`

---

4. astro.nu — the solar almanac

Sunrise, sunset, three grades of twilight, solar noon, day length, sun position, and moon phase, for any latitude and longitude (degrees; north and east positive). Times are local decimal hours given a UTC offset `tz`; `hm` renders them as "HH:MM". NOAA solar position algorithm, within about a minute of the `astral` reference library (`tests/39_astro.test`). A `places` record preloads coordinates for several cities.

```
neutrino> load("packages/astro.nu")
neutrino> hm(sunrise(places.alexandria_va.lat, places.alexandria_va.lon, 2026, 7, 10, -
4))
"05:52"
neutrino> hm(sunset(places.duluth_ga.lat, places.duluth_ga.lon, 2026, 7, 10, -4))
"20:50"
neutrino> hm(solar_noon(places.ljubljana.lon, 2026, 7, 10, 2))
"13:07"
neutrino> day_length(places.ljubljana.lat, places.ljubljana.lon, 2026, 7, 10)
15.5331
```

Planning a drive to arrive before dark — civil dawn at the origin to civil dusk at the destination:

```
neutrino> load("packages/astro.nu")
neutrino> let w = drive_daylight(places.alexandria_va, places.duluth_ga, 2026, 7, 10, -
4)
{depart_dawn = 5.34382, depart_rise = 5.86728, arrive_set = 20.8376, arrive_dusk = 21.3161, window_h
neutrino> hm(w.depart_dawn) + " to " + hm(w.arrive_dusk)
"05:21 to 21:19"
neutrino> w.window_hours
15.9723
```

Sun position, moon illumination, and the honest polar refusal:

```
neutrino> load("packages/astro.nu")
error: the sun does not cross 90.833 degrees at latitude 80 on 2026-6-21
neutrino> let p = sun_position(38.8048, -77.0469, 2026, 7, 10, 13.22, -4)
{alt = 73.3594, az = 179.65}
neutrino> p.alt
73.3594
neutrino> moon_illum(2026, 7, 10)
0.19449
```

```
neutrino> sunrise(80, 0, 2026, 6, 21, 0)
```

Function	Worked example	Result
`sunrise(lat, lon, y, m, d, tz)`	`hm(sunrise(38.8048, -77.0469, 2026, 7, 17, -4))`	`"05:57"`
`sunset(lat, lon, y, m, d, tz)`	`hm(sunset(38.8048, -77.0469, 2026, 7, 17, -4))`	`"20:31"`
`dawn_civil / dusk_civil(lat, lon, y, m, d, tz)`	`hm(dawn_civil(38.8048, -77.0469, 2026, 7, 17, -4))`	`"05:26"`
`dawn_nautical / dusk_nautical(lat, lon, y, m, d, tz)`	`hm(dawn_nautical(38.8048, -77.0469, 2026, 7, 17, -4))`	`"04:48"`
`dawn_astro / dusk_astro(lat, lon, y, m, d, tz)`	`hm(dusk_astro(38.8048, -77.0469, 2026, 7, 17, -4))`	`"22:23"`
`solar_noon(lon, y, m, d, tz)`	`hm(solar_noon(-77.0469, 2026, 7, 17, -4))`	`"13:14"`
`day_length(lat, lon, y, m, d)`	`day_length(46.0569, 14.5058, 2026, 7, 17)`	`15.3443`
`sun_position(lat, lon, y, m, d, hour, tz)`	`sun_position(38.8048, -77.0469, 2026, 7, 17, 13.2, -4).alt`	`72.2914`
`moon_age(y, m, d)`	`moon_age(2026, 7, 17)`	`2.70686`
`moon_illum(y, m, d)`	`moon_illum(2026, 7, 17)`	`0.0806581`
`hm(h)`	`hm(6.05)`	`"06:03"`
`places`	`places.duluth_ga.lat`	`34.0029`
`drive_daylight(from, to, y, m, d, tz)`	`drive_daylight(places.alexandria_va, places.duluth_ga, 2026, 7, 17, -4).window_hours`	`15.8284`

---

5. rmt.nu — random matrices, structured

`packages/rmt.nu` is sugar over `randn`/`qr`/`eye` for the matrices you actually reach for at the prompt: symmetric, positive definite (chol-safe by construction: eigenvalues at least 1), Haar orthogonal, permutations and their matrices, correlation, row-stochastic (random Markov chains), and the Gaussian orthogonal ensemble — whose spectrum follows Wigner's semicircle on [-2, 2], as the last line demonstrates on a 200×200 draw. Everything is reproducible under `rng(seed)`.

```
neutrino> load("packages/rmt.nu")
neutrino> format(6)
neutrino> rng(11)
neutrino> randorth(2)
[0.684752, 0.728776; -0.728776, 0.684752]
neutrino> let P = randspd(3); chol(P)[1, 1] > 0
true
neutrino> randperm(6)
[4, 5, 1, 2, 3, 6]
neutrino> permmat([3, 1, 2])
```

```
[0, 0, 1; 1, 0, 0; 0, 1, 0]
neutrino> let H = goe(200); max(abs(eig(H).values))
1.99476
```

Function	Worked example	Result
`randsym(n)`	`let S = randsym(3); max(max(abs(S - S'))) == 0`	`true`
`randspd(n)`	`let P = randspd(3); min(eig(P).values) >= 1`	`true`
`wishart(n)`	`let W = wishart(3); min(eig(W).values) > 0`	`true`
`randorth(n)`	`let Q = randorth(3); max(max(abs(Q' * Q - eye(3)))) < 1e-12`	`true`
`randperm(n)`	`sort(randperm(5)) == 1:5`	`[true, true, true, true, true]`
`permmat(p)`	`permmat([2, 3, 1])`	`[0, 1, 0; 0, 0, 1; 1, 0, 0]`
`randcorr(n)`	`let C = randcorr(3); max(abs(diag(C) - 1)) < 1e-12`	`true`
`randstoch(n)`	`let T = randstoch(4); max(abs(sum(T, 2) - 1)) < 1e-12`	`true`
`goe(n)`	`let H = goe(150); max(abs(eig(H).values)) < 2.4`	`true`

6. phys.nu — physical constants

`packages/phys.nu` is the CODATA 2018 constants as a record — exact where the 2019 SI redefinition makes them exact (`c`, `h`, `k`, `NA`, `qe`), the recommended values elsewhere. The transcript computes Earth's surface gravity from `G`, recovers the speed of light from Maxwell's relation `1/sqrt(eps0*mu0)`, and expresses thermal energy at room temperature in electron volts:

```
neutrino> load("packages/phys.nu")
neutrino> format(6)
neutrino> phys.c
299792458
neutrino> phys.hbar
1.05457e-34
neutrino> phys.G * 5.972e24 / 6.371e6 ^ 2
9.81997
neutrino> 1 / sqrt(phys.eps0 * phys.mu0)
2.99792e+08
neutrino> phys.k * 300 / phys.eV
0.0258520
```

Function	Worked example	Result
`phys.c`	`phys.c == 299792458`	`true`
`phys.h`	`phys.h`	`6.62607e-34`
`phys.hbar`	`abs(phys.hbar * 2 * pi - phys.h) < 1e-45`	`true`
`phys.G`	`phys.G`	`6.67430e-11`
`phys.k (thermal, in eV)`	`phys.k * 300 / phys.eV`	`0.0258520`

Function	Worked example	Result
`phys.NA`	`phys.NA == 6.02214076e23`	`true`
`phys.R`	`phys.R`	`8.31446`
`phys.qe`	`phys.qe`	`1.60218e-19`
`phys.alpha`	`1 / phys.alpha`	`137.036`
`phys.sigma`	`phys.sigma`	`5.67037e-08`
`phys.ly / phys.au`	`phys.ly / phys.au`	`63241.1`

7. scatter.nu — scatter plots without touching the core

Proof that the frozen language plots more than it appears to: `plot()`'s `style = "points"` option is honored by every backend (SVG circles in the browser, point markers in ascii and gnuplot), so scatter plots are a pure package. `scatter(x, y)` and `scatter_titled(x, y, t)` wrap that fact; `jitter(x, amount)` spreads overplotted values for legibility. Per-point sizes and colors would need backend changes and are deliberately absent — the package's header says so. The transcript exercises the numeric helper; the SVG output itself is asserted by the plot test suite:

```
neutrino> load("packages/scatter.nu")
neutrino> rng(1); let j = jitter(1:100, 0.1);
neutrino> max(abs(j - (1:100))) <= 0.05
true
neutrino> size(jitter(rand(3, 4), 0.2))
[3, 4]
```

Function	Worked example	Result
`jitter(x, a)` stays within a/2	`max(abs(jitter(1:100, 0.1) - (1:100))) <= 0.05`	`true`
jitter preserves shape	`size(jitter(rand(3, 4), 0.2)) == [3, 4]`	`[true, true]`
mean displacement is small	`abs(mean(jitter(zeros(1, 2000), 0.2))) < 0.01`	`true`

8. symb.nu — symbolic differentiation

Pure showing off: a symbolic differentiator in pure Neutrino. Expressions are nested records built by constructors (`C(5)`, `X`, `add`, `mul`, `powc`, `sinx`, ...; there is deliberately no string parser — the string builtins have no substring access, so entry is constructor-style, in the spirit of RPN). `ddx` differentiates by structural recursion; `sub` and `divx` desugar into add/mul/negative powers at construction, so product, power, and chain rules alone carry the whole calculus — the quotient rule falls out of $d(b^{-1})$ for free. `simp` folds constants, `show` prints, `evalx` evaluates, `subst` composes, and `taylor` extracts series coefficients by repeated differentiation. The transcript cross-checks the symbolic answer against numeric differentiation — two independent derivatives agreeing inside one verified session:

```
neutrino> format(4)
neutrino> load("packages/symb.nu")
neutrino> let e = add(powc(X, 3), mul(C(5), sinx(X)));
neutrino> show(simp(ddx(e)))
"((3 * x^2) + (5 * cos(x)))"
neutrino> let d = fn f -> fn x -> (f(x + h) - f(x - h)) / (2 * h) where h = 1e-6
<fn/1>
neutrino> abs(evalx(ddx(e), 2) - d(fn t -> t ^ 3 + 5 * sin(t))(2)) < 1e-8
true
```

```
neutrino> show(dn(powc(X, 5), 3))
"(60 * x^2)"
neutrino> taylor(sinx(X), 7)
[0.000, 1.000, -0.000, -0.1667, 0.000, 0.008333, -0.000, -0.0001984]
neutrino> show(simp(ddx(subst(expx(X), mul(C(2), X)))))
"(2 * exp((2 * x)))"
```

That last-but-one line is the sine series — 0, 1, 0, −1/6, 0, 1/120, … — recovered from pure record recursion.

And since v2.13.1 established that strings index like arrays (and always did), the package now carries **the parser that was possible all along**: recursive descent over `s[i]`, character classes as chained comparisons (`"0" <= c <= "9"`), general powers desugared as f^g = exp(g·log f) so even x^x differentiates. The printer knows division and subtraction, so the quotient rule reads as the textbook writes it. And `tofun`/`ffun`/`dfun` lift results back into function-space — `dfun("sin(x)/x")` is an ordinary function, ready for `fzero`, `integral`, and the pipes. String in, string out:

```
neutrino> load("packages/symb.nu")
neutrino> deriv("sin(x)/x")
"((cos(x) / x) - (sin(x) / x^2))"
neutrino> deriv("x^3 + 5*sin(x)")
"((3 * x^2) + (5 * cos(x)))"
neutrino> deriv("x^x")
"(exp((x * log(x))) * (log(x) + (x / x)))"
neutrino> deriv("log(x^2 + 1)")
"(2 * (x / (x^2 + 1)))"
neutrino> taylor(parse("exp(x)"), 4)
[1, 1, 0.5, 0.166667, 0.0416667]
```

Function	Worked example	Result
d/dx of x^3 at 2 is 12	`evalx(ddx(powc(X, 3)), 2) == 12`	true
chain rule through exp(2x)	`abs(evalx(ddx(subst(expx(X), mul(C(2), X))), 0) - 2) < 1e-12`	true
taylor of exp begins 1, 1, 1/2	`max(abs(taylor(expx(X), 2) - [1, 1, 0.5])) < 1e-9`	true
parse then evaluate	`abs(evalx(parse("2*pi"), 0) - 2 * pi) < 1e-12`	true
deriv: string in, string out	`deriv("x^2") == "(2 * x)"`	true
dfun: derivative as a function	`abs(dfun("x^3")(2) - 12) < 1e-12`	true
FTC: integral of dfun is the change	`abs(integral(dfun("x^3"), 1, 2) - 7) < 1e-6`	true

Writing your own

The pattern all four follow: a file of `let` definitions, `assert`-validated inputs, a record of closures when a namespace helps, and a golden test file whose reference values come from an independent implementation. Multi-line definitions are fine wherever a bracket is open. `save` your workspace, `load` it tomorrow — a package is just a workspace you chose to keep.